

When is expensive perception worth paying for?

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ONE RECORDED RUN PER VIEW · NOTHING ON THIS SCREEN IS LIVE

■ Same task, three ways of seeing it, three different bills.

IF YOU BUILD A WEB AGENT

Should it look, read, or both — and can it learn to choose?

1

How do the views
behave?

2

How do they fail?

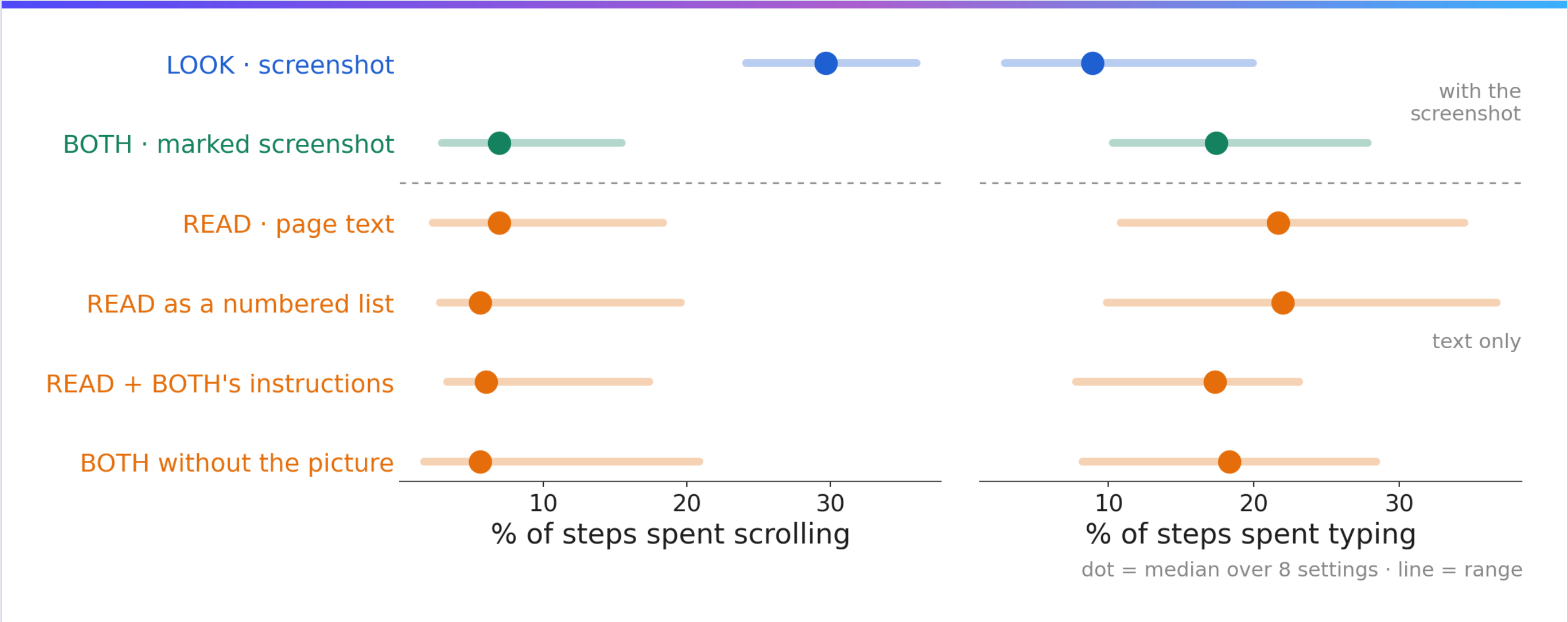
3

What does picking
right buy?

4

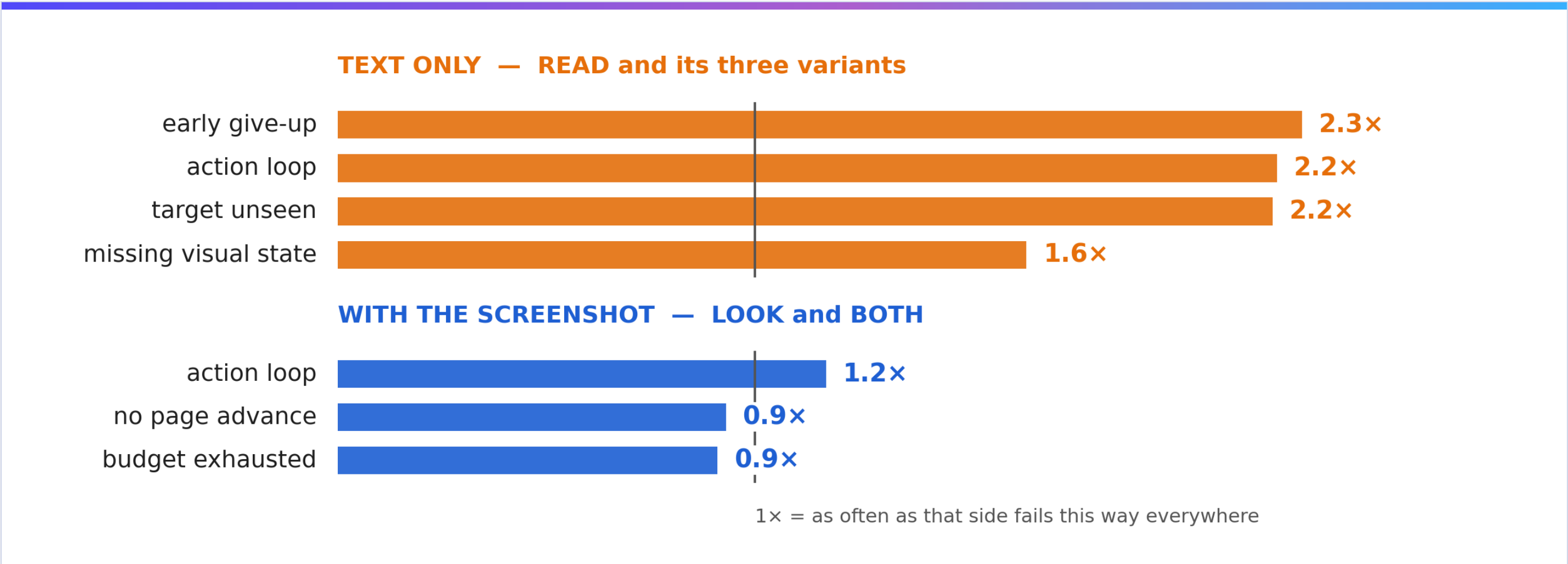
Can it be learned?

■ With only the screenshot, the agent scrolls far more and types far less.



Medians over 8 settings: LOOK scrolls in **about 30%** of its steps, every other view **about 6%**; it types about half as often

■ Text-only views fail in ways you can name; views with the screenshot just never get there.



Each side vs its own failures elsewhere · text-only: several over **2x** · LOOK and BOTH: none stands out · six VisualWebArena settings

③ PICKING RIGHT

■ Your coding agent checks its fix in a browser. Pick the right view:

+11 to +16

more tasks solved per 100

−7 to −29%

CO₂e (estimate)

up to −34%

time (same on 2 of 3 sites)

Large model · 3 sites · hindsight vs the best fixed view

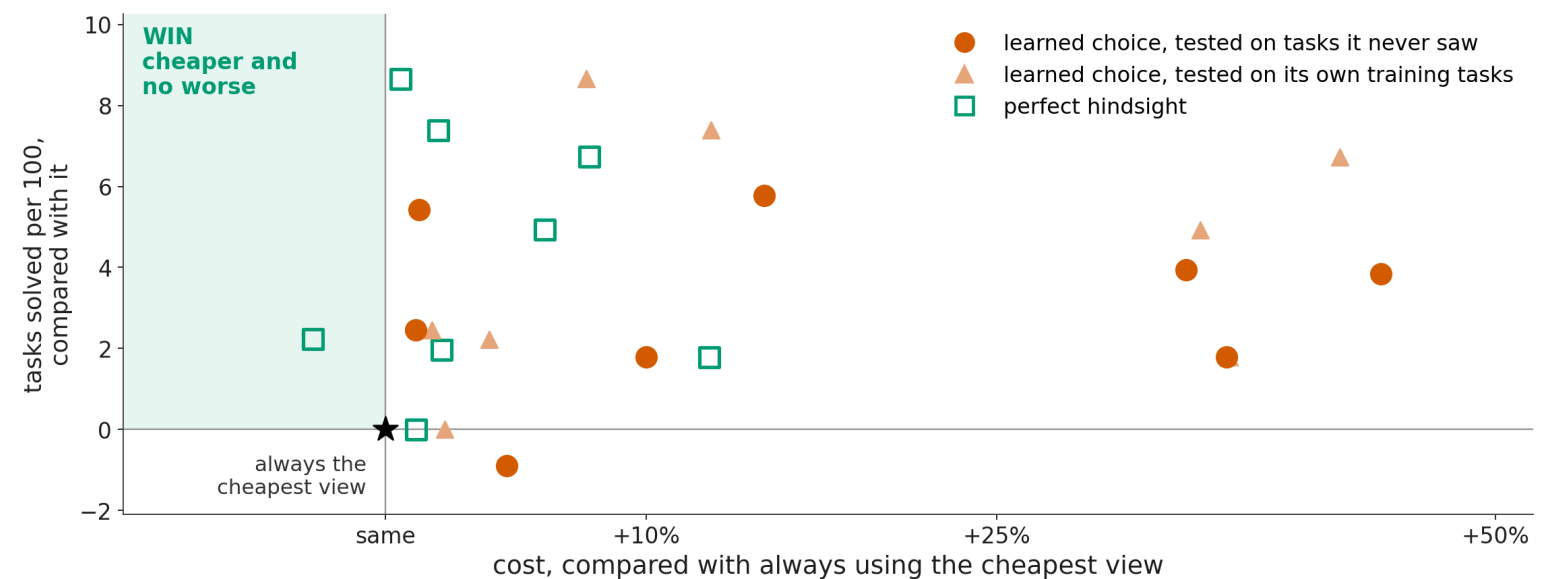
④ CAN IT LEARN TO PICK?

■ Not today: nothing we trained picks well enough to beat the cheapest view.

0 of 8

settings where a learned picker beats
always using the cheapest view

Even perfect hindsight: 1 of 8

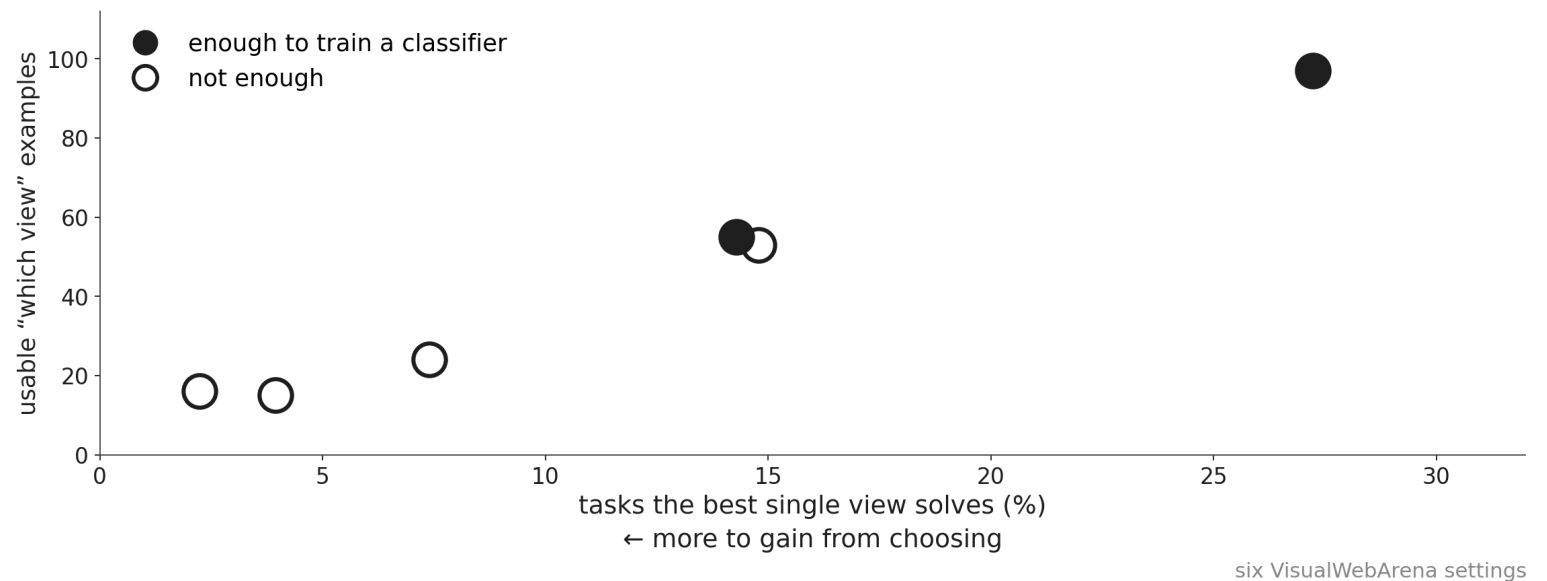


■ Routing's scaling law: no wins, no examples.

2–4×

at least this many more tasks for the settings short of examples

You only learn which view was right from tasks the agent solved



NOT YET

■ Improve the agent first, collect reliable examples, then learn when to look.

WHAT IT TAKES

- a stronger agent
- at least **2–4×** more tasks
- reruns that agree

THREE ASKS

- ✓ type a task at the board
- ✓ which view do you use?
- ✓ lend us a stronger agent

Look, read, or both?
It depends on the task.
Nothing we trained knows it yet.



Come to the board — try your own task, live in all three views.

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REFERENCE – TASK 130, RECORDED STEPPING, 39 S